

MY CORNER OF THE WORLD · VOLUME 2

Listen. Pass. Play fair.

The team's patched ball splits open for the third time, just as Lamine was about to score. He is twelve and he knows exactly what he wants to be: a professional soccer player, like Sadio Mané, who grew up in the very same village. His father, Baba, has another plan. Baba is a griot, a keeper of family memory, and Lamine is supposed to learn the names, the stories and the drum that go with them.

Then Cheikh comes home from a soccer academy in shiny white cleats and says they play with garbage. Lamine answers with a challenge: a real match, less than three weeks away. To get ready, he starts cutting corners with his time: late for errands, small lies, friends pushed around on the field. And the people who love him begin to pay for his dream.

A novel in journal form about two rhythms, the beat of a drum and the bounce of a ball, and about a boy who has to learn to listen before he can find his place in either. For readers 9 to 12, alone or read aloud.

AGES 9-12

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The Drum and the Ball

Lamine's Journal